

DANIEL MASON

PERSONAL STATEMENT

Daniel is currently working on a YouTube series (and accompanying online book) teaching Rust.

Daniel constantly looks at how new technologies and techniques can be used to improve the quality of his work, however, he always weighs potential gains against required investment. At home, Daniel runs his own multi architecture kubernetes cluster. At Beamery, he introduced Stub Adaptors for testing, significantly improving the testability of code and type safety. At Peloton, Daniel pioneered structured content, empowering copy editors with minimal engineering input and significantly simplifying code. At Triptease, he encouraged and helped people wanting to learn Rust. At Apolitical, Daniel evangelised kubernetes, docker, Node and Rust and coached colleagues in their use. At MOO, he evangelised Docker and CD Pipelines to increase developer confidence and code quality, as well as pushing for more testing and quality control.

Daniel can pick up new languages, frameworks and techniques very quickly, and loves to do so. He constantly looks for new ways to improve on what he's already doing.

SKILLS

Daniel is a skilled engineer and leader, with experience in a wide range of languages, tools and practices. This is an incomplete list of technologies Daniel is competent with:

Leadership:	Architecture, Tech Evangelist, People Management, Coaching, Mentoring, Triage
Languages:	TypeScript, Rust, JavaScript, Node.js, MySQL/Maria, Postgres
Quality Control:	GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, rustdoc, Jest, ESLint, Prettier, Mocha, mdBook
Methodology:	Agile, TDD, BDD, DDD, Cross Team Collaboration, Stakeholder Management
Frameworks:	Next.js, Express, Actix Web, Diesel, Dioxus, React, Rocket
Source Management:	Git, GitHub, GitLab, Cargo, Crates.io, NPM, Yarn, Docker Hub
WebOps:	Kubernetes, GKE, GCP, Docker, AWS, Linux

EXPERIENCE

Further details can be given on request

Rust, simply - Founder, Write and Presenter Jan 2024 - Today

At the beginning of 2024 Daniel began working on Rust, simply, a website, YouTube channel and community devoted to demystifying the Rust programming language. The website is built in Dioxus, a Rust based frontend web framework which Daniel also used for his personal site after trying a few similar frameworks for a presentation on the topic of Rust in the Frontend. The main project for Rust, simply is Idiomatic Rust in Simple Steps, a series teaching Rust from scratch. There is a book written using mdbook, and the video series was created with Davinci Resolve, where Daniel had to learn to create all the effects and animations.

Beamery - Tech Lead / Principal Engineer Nov 2022 - Dec 2023

The largest and most important project Daniel architected at Beamery was the Candidate Authentication System which allowed candidates to sign into Beamery's clients job portals without storing passwords. Daniel was also heavily involved with the frontend and backend tribes, helping organise and present content as well as writing and presenting a number of "lunch and learn"s. One of his smaller but more impactful contributions was helping his team skill up on test driven development, continuous deployment and better understanding and utilising the tools they already had.

Peloton - Engineering Manager

June 2021 - Nov 2022

Moving into a full time management role allowed Daniel to focus on building out his team and optimising its structure and processes. This started with hiring three new engineers, and bringing in four contractors. This provided the scale we needed to begin delivering our bigger initiatives. Daniel then split the team into two sub-squads, delegating some of the leadership to his two more senior engineers. The squads could then specialise on internationalisation and localisation tasks separately. Daniel's biggest efforts have been put into helping his reports pursue career goals by tying their development areas into Pelotons career ladder and the businesses long term ambitions. Daniels has focused on cultivating an environment that allows his team members to succeed and grow.

Peloton - Engineering Lead

Sept 2020 - June 2021

Daniel joined Peloton's new international ecommerce team, with two reports. Initially work was mostly adding market specific changes to a monolithic frontend React app. The first significant project was the global financing page, and this is when he noticed a problem: adding a single page with next to no functionality, took two and a half developers a full two weeks to deliver. Daniel identified several problems in the development process that caused this, in particular, existing code was rarely reusable, and every page had to be tailor made by engineers. Daniel presented a demo using "structured content" that allowed copy editors to build pages themselves, using a handful of components. This idea was then used by his team to deliver the Australia Launch page, and gave them a much higher degree of confidence in their work and allowed the product owner to add pages herself without additional engineering support.

Triptease Ltd - Senior Software Engineer

Oct 2019 - Sept 2020

Daniel joined the Retargeting team at Triptease, which was just coming out of its greenfield MVP phase, and moving to sustaining growth, optimisation and a steady release of features. Work was almost always performed in pairs, not just with engineers but also design, data science or project management. Daniel proposed and implemented "responsive" ads, to both speed up development and fix a bug caused by ad networks misreporting ad size. In addition to his work duties Daniel took part in the career coaching framework both as a coach and a coachee. Daniel was also a regular at Triptease's Coding Dojo.

Apolitical Group Ltd - Senior Software Engineer

Nov 2017 - Oct 2019

Daniel planned, designed, and delivered the Kubernetes microservice architecture that allowed Apolitical to grow from around a struggling 1000 user Wordpress site, to over 38,000 when he left. Daniel mentored Apolitical's two juniors. The first, a Ruby developer who skilled up in Node and JS, and became the authority on our frontend work. The second, an engineer straight out of a bootcamp who Daniel taught Rust, and became the authority on Apolitical's Rust services. This would later serve as motivation for Rust, simply.

MOO Print Ltd - Software Engineer

May 2016 - Nov 2017

Daniel helped take a greenfield project from the drawing board and into production. As with Apolitical, Daniel's biggest achievement at MOO was coaching a junior engineer. Here he was given the opportunity to coach someone from a non-engineering team and help them move to Junior Software Engineer over the course of two months, and at the end she joined his team and was immediately a significant contributor.

The Foundry Visionmongers - Web Developer

Oct 2014 -May 2016

Daniel was the sole in-house developer on the Made With Mischief web services. He introduced high quality testing and added an API to provide facilities such as auto updates for the desktop app.

Loft Digital - LAMP Developer

Sept 2011 – Oct 2014

Daniel worked with clients to deliver web services. Daniel's biggest achievement was working onsite at the Homeless World Cup in Poznan. Daniel provided extra value to both the sports and media teams.

CONTACT DETAILS

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